

STEP INTO THE WORLD OF THE BESTSELLING MUSLIM COMIC SERIES LOVED BY MILLIONS OF READERS WORLDWIDE.

15 YEARS OF ILLUSTRATIONS

annotated and explained by the author

MUSLIM SHOW

"LET'S DRAW A LINE OVER OUR ERA!"

ALLAM

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"In 2009, I decided to launch the Muslim Show series, after reading several books which opened my eyes to the Islam that I knew so little about.

Having no reference on what a "Muslim" comic strip should look like, I set myself rules that will follow me throughout my career:
- Never illustrate Prophets or companions, as well as anything that is part of the invisible world (angels, demons, Paradise, Hell, etc.).
- Never make fun of religion, nor ridicule the role of the imam or the scholar.
- Do not be rude or vulgar.

Measures dooming any comic book series project to failure, if we were to believe the trends of the time, and yet it was quite the opposite!
We were very quickly adopted by a public that was also an orphan.

In 2015, I decided to change my graphic style and borrow a design mixing black silhouette and cartoon; this in order to definitively protect myself from the ban on pictorial representation in Islam.
A difficult change, technically, but also complex with certain media seeing this act as a sign of ideological radicalization.
From a Muslim cartoonist, I had moved on to an Islamic cartoonist (!).

After fifteen years of existence, hundreds of drawings, millions of views and "likes" on social networks, I said to myself that perhaps it was time that I explained my approach and my thoughts behind my drawings… in order to avoid any "blurry".

A picture is worth a thousand words, they say.
But a thousand words avoid a thousand misunderstandings."

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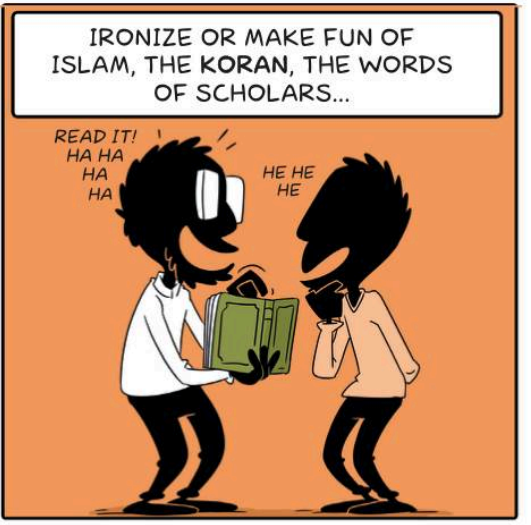






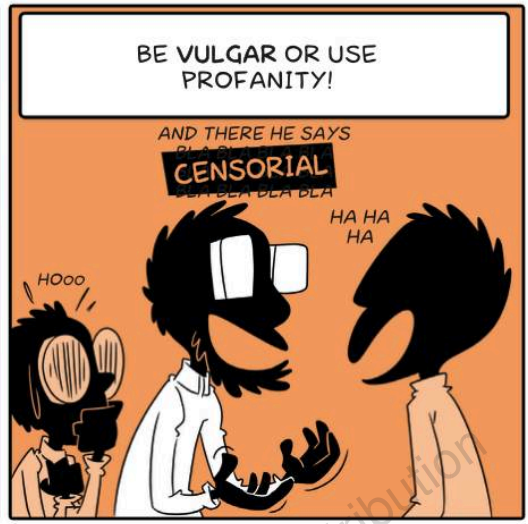






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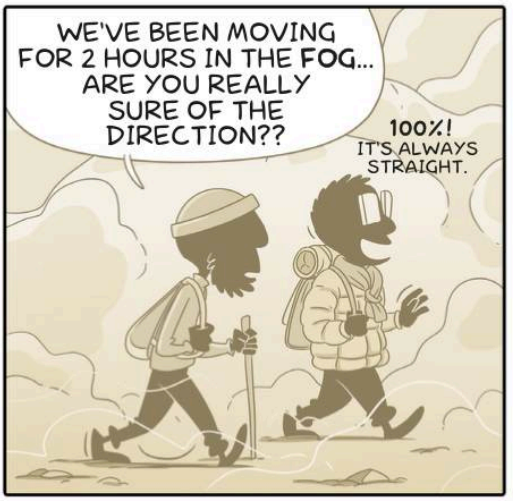
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"Even if cartoons represent barely 20% of the content of the series, the Muslim Show has always been affiliated with humor.
To tell the truth, this is not totally false since at the time the choice was made to demonstrate that it was possible to use humor while remaining modest, ethical, and above all, devoid of vulgarity; the latter having appeared well before social networks.

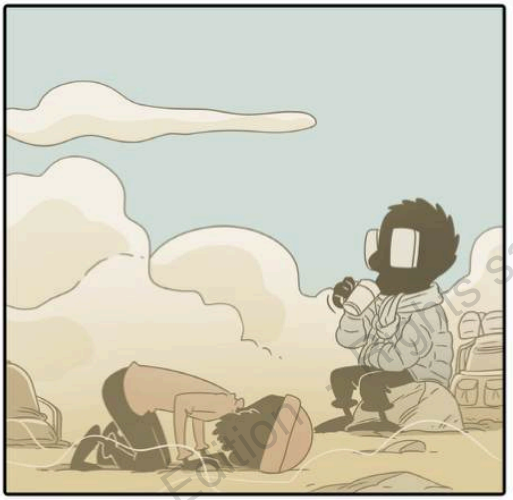
To those who wonder about how to be funny while respecting so many rules, I will simply answer that it is, sometimes, better to trade a potential burst of nasty laughter for a simple respectful smile.

Controlled humor rises to the top of good behavior."

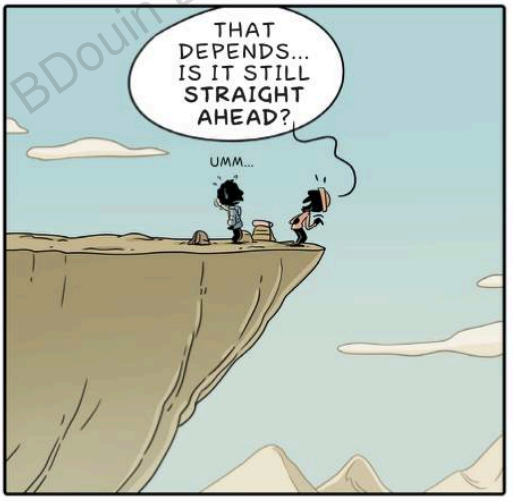
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"The mist appears as a recurring graphic motif in the series, symbolizing periods of uncertainty and doubt.

Some venture into it, advancing without discernment, while others prefer to wait, letting the dust settle. It is a complex situation, requiring both restraint, as one loses bearings and direction, and energy. Therefore, it is necessary to leave this paralyzing zone as quickly as possible.

As always, in difficult times, it is with Allah that help is found."

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"Here, it's not just about money.
The treasure represents all the riches that a person might hope to uncover in this world: whether material, human, or professional.
This is the Dunya.

However, unlike the greedy individual, the envious person has an even more deplorable characteristic: they can only conceive happiness in having more than their neighbor.
And if they cannot achieve this situation, they will employ all possible means and redouble their efforts to ensure that their neighbor has less than them...

May Allah protect us from the evil eye."

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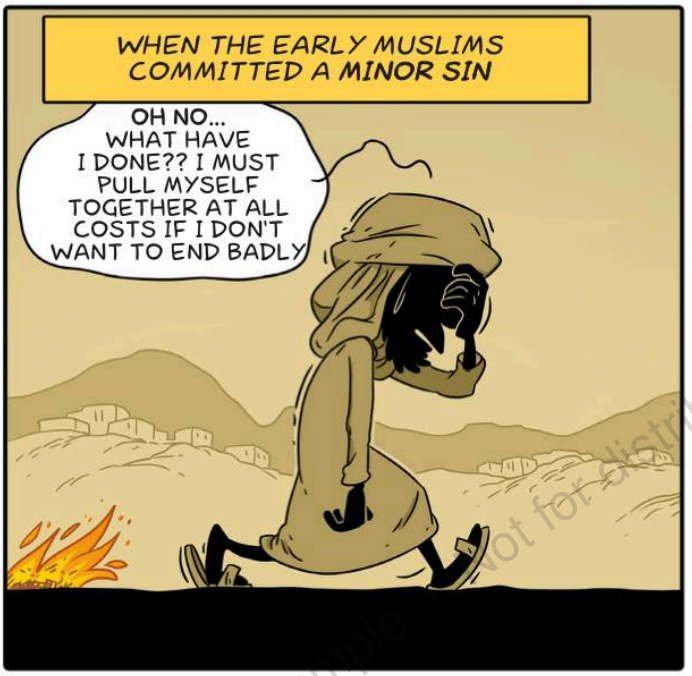
"A crowd drawn to convenience attracts another crowd reassured by the crowd.

The majority is often wrong. But the majority decides, thinking itself free in its choices, not seeing that it is being gently led to the slaughterhouse by being brushed with the grain...

It doesn't matter to walk alone, as long as it leads to the truth."

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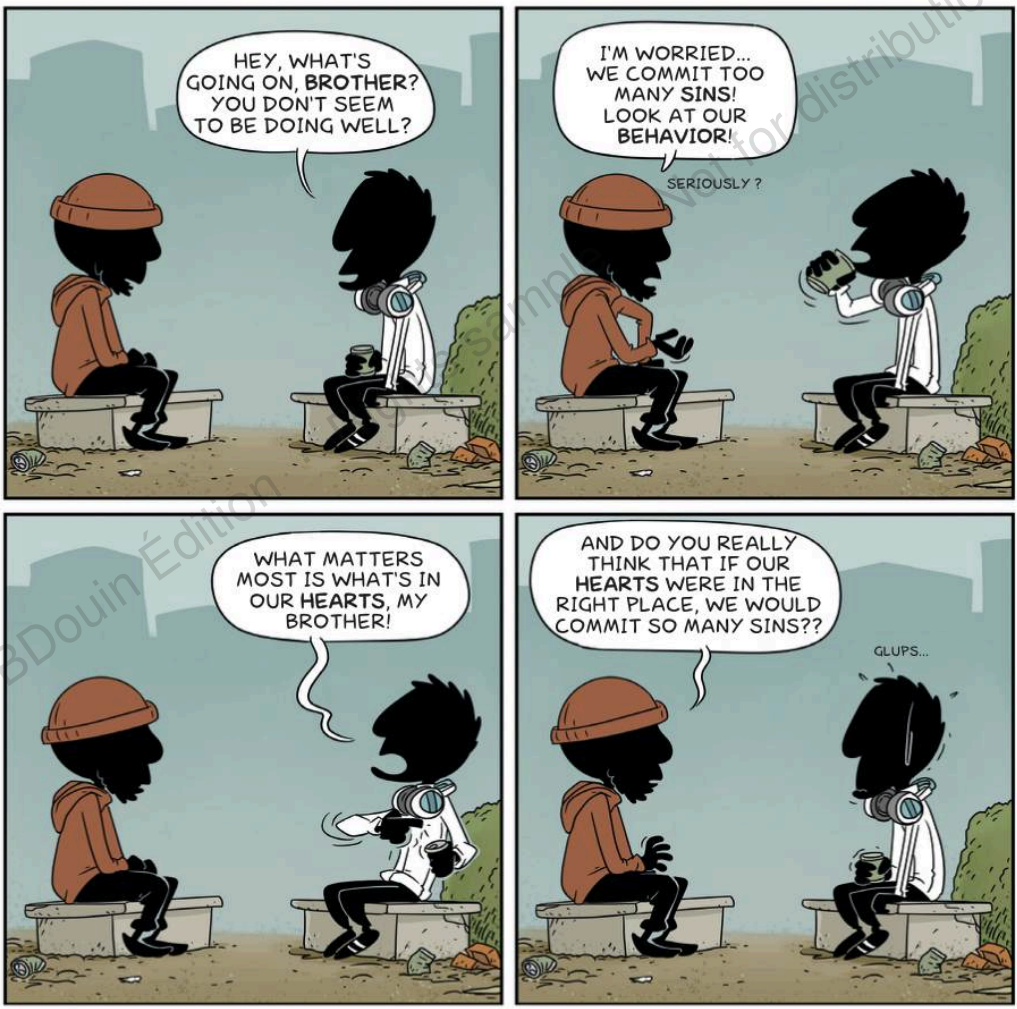


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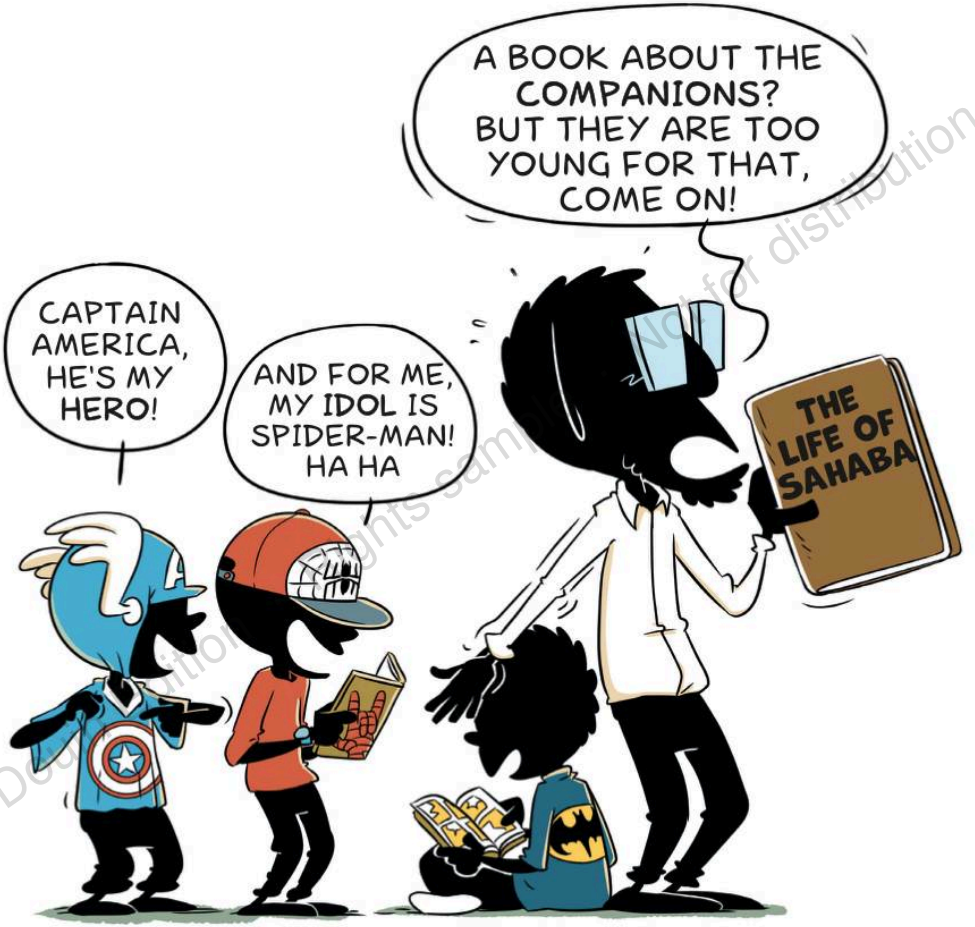
"The outward appearance of a Muslim reflects the true nature of their being. Indeed, every action stems from the intentions of their heart; if the heart is impure, it will be evident even in the features of their face.

Therefore, one must be an observer of their own behavior, seeking out their shortcomings, and not fearing self-criticism if they aspire to reach their best self."



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"Education is about providing role models for children. And if you don't, others will take care of it for you...

In this illustration, there are two closely related messages: a father who thinks his children are too young to learn about the lives of the early Muslims and prefers to let them have fun; and then, this same father not realizing that contemporary entertainment is replacing what learning about the companions' lives could have provided them: a model for adult life.

Fake superheroes have replaced our real heroes in the hearts of the youth, under the watchful eye of parents who have underestimated them. Who are they? Their children."

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